Staff answers and cover notes

Suggested responses for fictional cases. Accept other safe, reasoned responses. Do not infer a learner's personal circumstances from classroom work.

Key teaching points

• A safe disagreement leaves each person free to say no, pause or seek help.

• Calm listening may help when both people feel safe. A shared plan must be freely chosen.

• Pressure, control or fear needs adult help. The person under pressure is not to blame.

• Tell a trusted adult or the safeguarding lead. Try another trusted adult if needed. Get staff help at once if danger is happening now.

Vocabulary

Conflict: A disagreement about needs, ideas or choices.

Boundary: A limit a person sets about what they will accept or do.

Respect: Treating a person's needs and choices as mattering.

Control: Trying to take away another person's freedom to choose.

Support: Help from a safe person, such as a trusted adult or the safeguarding lead.

Worked model

This is a safe disagreement. Each person has a voice and a real choice. Taking turns may help. An agreement works only if both choose it freely. If fear, pressure or control appears, stop the joint problem-solving task and get adult help.

Starter claim

Every relationship problem needs both people to compromise.

Safe disagreements may use shared problem-solving. Pressure, control or fear needs adult support and safety; a person need not give up a boundary to keep the peace.

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Case answers and checks

A change of plan

Both can say no, and a pause is accepted. They could listen in turn, explain the choice calmly or make separate plans. A shared plan needs free agreement. Disappointment alone does not remove the other person's choice. Adult support remains available.

Rules for a friend

Repeated demands for updates, rules about other friends and worry about saying no are warning signs. This is not a fair difference to split down the middle. The worried person is not to blame. They can stop the discussion, seek a safer place with adult support and tell a trusted adult or the safeguarding lead. They do not need to confront the friend or bargain away their choices.

The first adult is busy

No. The learner can tell another trusted adult or the safeguarding lead and say that help is needed. A private opener could be: A learner feels afraid to say no and needs help to stay safe. They need not give details to peers. If danger is happening now, get staff help at once through the urgent safety procedure. A peer's role is to seek adult help, not investigate or fix the relationship.

Hinge and decision

Main key B: Fear and rules that take away choice need adult help. The person does not have to negotiate control or confront someone alone. If danger is happening now, get staff help at once.

Parallel key A: Calm discussion is an option when both feel safe and have a real choice. Nobody has to give in, and either may pause or ask for adult help.

Check privately. Proceed with a safe reason from each learner. If unsafe or unclear, re-model, use the parallel check and guide the next case. Keep normal access aids. A pass needs a later opportunity, not a negative inference.

Misconception response

If the first adult is busy, the learner must sort it out alone.

The learner can tell another trusted adult or the safeguarding lead. A peer can help them reach staff, but should not investigate, mediate an unsafe situation or promise secrecy.

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Delivery boundaries and evidence

Use the invented text only. Do not ask about pupils' relationships, families, messages or experiences. Do not pair learners to act as a controlling person and a worried person. No role-play, confrontation or mediation exercise. Optional pair analysis: role A finds a story clue; role B chooses a safe next step; swap on the next card. Each learner keeps an individual response, and solo or staff-supported work is equally valid. For Case 2, do not frame control as mutual poor communication or invite bargaining over boundaries. A concern does not require pupils to decide a label or prove abuse before asking for help. Route any disclosure to the safeguarding lead under school procedure, listen without probing or promising secrecy, and use a separate safeguarding record. If a learner cannot name a trusted adult, support them privately. Pre-agree a discreet supervised pause, neutral task and supported return. Record actual aids and content prompts separately. Evidence shows classroom reasoning, not proof that a learner is safe or responsible for managing another person's behaviour. Award references must say only the unit award. Week 4 is held and is neither taught nor assessed here.

Route guidance

Supported: Offer the word bank, visible model, short choices and sentence frame. Keep normal aids and record the learner's own choice.

Independent: Keep glossary and usual aids. Learner chooses the evidence, gives a reason and records a next step.

Aspire: Keep normal aids. Compare plausible choices, justify the safer response and adapt a help route. No personal detail or longer writing is required.

Evidence criteria

Recognises safe disagreement and unsafe pressure: Uses a story detail about free choice, accepted limits, control or fear; avoids guessing from one emotion alone.

Chooses a response that fits safety: Calm listening or a pause only where both feel safe; adult help where control or fear is present; no forced compromise or confrontation.

Uses an adult help route: Names a trusted adult and the safeguarding lead by role; chooses another adult if the first is unavailable; gets staff help at once for danger now.

Safeguarding and response

Listen calmly to any disclosure. Do not probe, investigate or promise secrecy. Follow the school safeguarding procedure and pass concerns promptly to the safeguarding lead. Use the separate safeguarding record; keep real concerns out of learning evidence. Privately support a learner who cannot identify a trusted adult.

Use the agreed pause signal. No public reason is needed. An adult supports the agreed supervised route, a neutral task and a supported return. A learner may pass, observe or catch up privately. Keep supervision in place.

VF verbal feedback · WS worked with support · I independent · NS next step in green · // self-edit · ? read this back to me · E actual evidence banked · R responded. R only after Voice and Audience are present, one NS is set and the learner responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode.

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